

ML FROM PRIMITIVES

2026 EDITION

ML Interview Workbook

A compact, printable companion for evidence-based preparation.

Use this with the visual field guide. Choose the work your loop actually requires, attempt it closed-book, record what happened, and schedule the smallest repair. This PDF is a blank companion; your private, browser-local plan lives in the Workbook.

Candidate: _____

Loop date: _____

How to use it

1. **Start from evidence.** Record confirmed rounds, time available, and recent closed-book performance.
2. **Choose three repairs.** Prefer high-relevance gaps over broad coverage.
3. **Attempt, compare, retry.** Keep the answer closed until the attempt ends; score observable behavior; schedule the next attempt.
4. **Graduate carefully.** Two spaced successful attempts plus an unfamiliar follow-up is stronger evidence than fluent repetition.

1. Loop snapshot

Target role: _____

Level: _____

Primary domain: _____

Weeks available: _____

Hours per week: _____

Interview date: _____

Confirmed round formats

- ☐ ML breadth / fundamentals
- ☐ Modeling / experimentation
- ☐ LLM systems / inference
- ☐ Behavioral / leadership
- ☐ Coding / implementation

- ☐ ML system design
- ☐ Training / debugging
- ☐ Project deep-dive
- ☐ Research / work sample
- ☐ Other: _____

2. Evidence scorecard

Score only recent timed, closed-book evidence. 0 means not attempted; 3 means workable timed answer; 5 means two spaced successes plus an unfamiliar follow-up.							
Area	0	1	2	3	4	5 / evidence note	
Fundamentals	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		
Production / systems	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		
LLM systems	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		
Retrieval / search	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		
System design	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		
Experimentation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		
Behavioral / leadership	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		
Math / research	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		
Coding / implementation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐		

3. First three repairs

Choose repairs by relevance, evidence, and leverage. A repair should name an action, not a topic.

01 Gap / round: _____
 Closed-book action: _____
 Observable success: _____
 Retry date: _____

02 Gap / round: _____
 Closed-book action: _____
 Observable success: _____
 Retry date: _____

03 Gap / round: _____
 Closed-book action: _____
 Observable success: _____
 Retry date: _____

4. Story bank prompts

For each story, keep the ownership and evidence explicit. **Problem / stakes**

My decision

Alternatives rejected

Evidence / result

Failure or surprise

What I would change

5. Weekly operating loop

Monday	Pick the three highest-value repairs. Name the round and observable success.
Tuesday–Thursday	Attempt closed-book. Use a visual lesson only after the attempt. Record the missing mechanism or decision.
Friday	Retry one weak item and one unfamiliar transfer. Ask one changed-assumption follow-up.
Weekend	Review the evidence, update the plan, and remove work that is no longer relevant.
This week's focus	

What changed after an attempt?

Next action

6. Readiness gate

Do not graduate a critical gap on confidence alone.

- Two successful closed-book attempts on different days.
- No critical rubric dimension remains weak.
- One unfamiliar follow-up or changed assumption succeeds.
- One later mixed-session attempt remains workable.
- A peer, mentor, or interviewer has challenged at least one claim when possible.

Evidence I still need before calling this ready:

